CURRICULUM VITAE

Mark Maingi

Software engineer and technical founder. Four years building production systems end to end — pensions, insurance, property, education, freight — with a preference for products whose state is cheap to check.

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ROLE	Software engineer & founder
EXPERIENCE	4+ years
BASED IN	Nairobi, Kenya · UTC+3
AVAILABILITY	Open to new work

PROFILE

I build software for operations where a wrong answer is expensive: a pension transfer that moves someone's savings, an admissions list that decides who gets a place, a truck that is either loaded or not. The recurring problem in all of them is the same — making the system's own state legible enough that a person with limited attention can tell whether it is working.

I work end to end: framing the problem, choosing the architecture, and shipping the interface. Four years of that has meant founding an education platform, delivering 20+ products for clients across five sectors, taking a regulated pension-transfer workflow from blank page to working proof of concept inside an insurer, and building agentic tools where the model has to act without supervision.

01 — FOCUS

What I do

Three things the record below keeps doing.

01 **End-to-end product engineering**

Problem framing, architecture, interface and deployment, usually alone. Three products launched inside one quarter in late 2023, and a pension-consolidation proof of concept delivered inside an insurer's innovation unit.

02 **Applied AI, at the product layer**

An agentic tax assistant and a prompt-to-explainer-video pipeline. Both forced an explicit answer to where the model may act and what a human must be able to check afterwards.

03 **Systems built for verification**

Credential attestation, pension consolidation and freight coordination all reduce to the same move: making an expensive claim cheap to check. It is the pattern I keep choosing, in regulated and unregulated markets alike.

02 — WORK

Selected work

Four builds, with what each one needed and what it produced.

Learnwise Technologies

FOUNDER & LEAD ENGINEER · 2025 — PRESENT

PROBLEM — Schools run admissions, fees, timetables and results across spreadsheets and messaging groups. The operation is invisible until something breaks.

APPROACH — Built around the checkpoints a head teacher actually needs to see, with legibility as the design goal rather than feature count: an operator should be able to answer “is this working?” without reading every record.

OUTCOME — An education platform covering school operations and digital learning, led end to end from problem framing to deployment.

PensionPlus — Sanlam

UI/UX ENGINEER & FRONTEND · 2022 — 2023

PROBLEM — Members hold fragmented pensions across providers. Consolidation is high-trust and low-comprehension: the user commits money to a process they cannot observe.

APPROACH — Reduced a regulated transfer workflow to a sequence a member could follow and an operator could audit, working inside the insurer's innovation unit.

OUTCOME — A working proof of concept rather than a deck — a compliance-heavy process made verifiable by someone who is not a compliance officer.

VectorAfriq / PropertyFinder

PLATFORM DEVELOPER · 2023 — PRESENT

PROBLEM — A two-sided property marketplace across two national markets with different inventory and buyer expectations.

APPROACH — Search-first architecture, with listing pages built to answer the questions a buyer asks before making contact. One pattern reused across Kenya and Uganda instead of duplicated per market.

OUTCOME — Property platforms live in both markets — systems design that survived a second country, which is the test a one-off build fails.

Applied AI — EasyUshuru, Sparkmind

FOUNDER & BUILDER · 2025 — PRESENT

PROBLEM — Agentic products either do real work unsupervised or fall apart quietly. Both of these sit where a wrong answer is expensive: tax filing and generated teaching material.

APPROACH — Built an agentic tax assistant and a prompt-to-explainer-video pipeline. Both forced an explicit answer to where the model may act and what a human must be able to check afterwards.

OUTCOME — Two agentic tools shipped, with model failure modes handled at the product layer rather than in the prompt.

03 — RECORD

Experience

Founder & Developer · Learnwise Technologies — FEB 2025 — PRESENT

Product direction, architecture and full-stack delivery for an education platform covering school operations and digital learning.

Developer · CargoLink — NOV 2024 — PRESENT

Logistics platform matching returning trucks with available cargo to cut empty runs.

Founder & Developer · Forecast 254 — NOV 2023 — PRESENT

Prediction-market product: market mechanics, incentive design and frontend.

Developer · VectorAfriq Properties — DEC 2023 — PRESENT

Property platforms for Kenya and Uganda: listing architecture, search and discovery, lead capture.

Founder & Developer · Aminiblock — NOV 2023 — PRESENT

Blockchain credential model, designed around what a third party can confirm without trusting the issuer.

Product Designer & Developer · Brandlogs — SEP 2023 – NOV 2023

Product design and frontend for a brand studio.

Developer · Bountiful Safaris — MAY 2023 – SEP 2023

CRM development for customer workflows and operational visibility.

UI/UX Engineer & Web Developer · Sanlam — SEP 2022 – MAR 2023

Proof-of-concept pension transfer product inside the innovation and growth department.

04 – SKILLS

Technical skills

LANGUAGES

TypeScript · JavaScript · Python · PHP · SQL

FRAMEWORKS

Next.js · React · Node.js · Express · Django · Laravel

DATA

PostgreSQL · Supabase · REST APIs · Authentication

APPLIED AI

LangChain · OpenAI APIs · Agent workflows · Prompt and evaluation systems

DELIVERY

Vercel · Git and GitHub · WordPress · Webflow

05 – FOUNDATION

Education and certification

Kabarak University — 2022 – PRESENT

Computer Science

Associate of Science, in progress · Nakuru, Kenya

PROGRAMMING AND WEB

HTML · 2020 · CSS · 2021 · PHP · 2021 · SQL · 2021 · Responsive Web Design · 2021 · Python · 2021 · JavaScript · 2022

PROFESSIONAL

Risk Management · Sanlam · Data Protection · Sanlam

06 – EARLIER

Earlier

2020 – 2022

Freelance web developer and researcher: client builds, last-mile service delivery research, and co-founding a blockchain project for public verification of construction transactions.

FEB – APR 2020

Secondary school teacher. The classroom is where I learned that an explanation only counts if the person in front of you can act on it.

LOCATION	Nairobi, Kenya · UTC+3	RELOCATION	Open to relocation
LANGUAGES	English (fluent), Swahili (native)	REFERENCES	Available on request